

Laurens Goormachtigh

Head of Product | AI & Digital Platforms | AgTech & EdTech

Tanzania

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Profile

Product leader with 9+ years of experience building and scaling AI-enabled digital platforms across AgTech and EdTech. Currently Head of Product at Alliance of Bioversity International and CIAT, where I established the organization's first product function and lead development of AI-powered phenotyping tools deployed across Africa.

Track record includes scaling platforms used by millions of users, launching international products, securing €2M public innovation funding, and contributing to patented technologies. Passionate about translating cutting-edge science and AI into scalable products with global impact.

Experience

Alliance of Bioversity International and CIAT

Oct 2024 – Present

Head of Product

Arusha, Tanzania

- Established organization's first product function to transition from project-based delivery to scalable product development
- Built and hired cross-functional engineering team, delivering AI-enabled mobile and web tools for agricultural phenotyping
- Led development and deployment of Ona platform across breeding programs in Tanzania, Kenya, and Uganda
- Improved integration between software and machine learning pipelines, reducing trait extraction turnaround from weeks to <24 hours

Onside

Sep 2023 – Sep 2024

Senior Product Manager

Christchurch, New Zealand

- Introduced product discovery and delivery processes, reducing cycle time from 11 to 3 days
- Implemented customer feedback and prioritization systems improving roadmap clarity and stakeholder alignment

StudySmarter

Jan 2022 – Sep 2023

Senior Product Manager

Munich, Germany

- Led development of self-service job board platform, contributing to 9x growth
- Delivered AI product features and landing experiences supporting platform expansion to 10M monthly users
- Launched Textbook Solutions product reaching 1.3M monthly users in US market

Chessable

Jun 2020 – Dec 2021

Product Manager

Barcelona, Spain

- Launched Spanish platform version, generating €20K+ additional monthly revenue
- Led development of personalized learning feature using user gameplay data, improving retention by 9%
- Built product analytics dashboards to support investor reporting and growth strategy

8x8 Media AG

Jul 2018 – May 2020

Product Manager, Product Lead

Wellington, New Zealand

- Led product strategy and development of Chessimo learning platform
- Managed developers and designers, delivering mobile and web applications
- Defined long-term product vision, roadmap, and go-to-market strategy

Chess Minds

May 2018 – Jul 2019

Founder and General Manager

Bay of Plenty, New Zealand

- Founded and grew chess education business serving schools and private students
- Developed curriculum, website, and client acquisition strategy

Scion Research

Jan 2017 – May 2018

Materials Scientist

Rotorua, New Zealand

- Conducted applied research developing bio-based materials for industrial applications

Beaulieu International Group

Sep 2013 – Dec 2016

Process Development Engineer

Kruishoutem, Belgium

- Secured €2M government grant to fund corporate innovation initiatives
- Developed biodegradable materials concept resulting in international patent (first inventor)

Education

Quantic School of Business and Technology

Jan 2025 – Feb 2026

Master of Science in Software Engineering

Washington DC, USA

Quantic School of Business and Technology

Master of Business Administration

Ghent University

Master of Science Bio-engineering

Feb 2019 – Mar 2020

Washington DC, USA

Sep 2011 – Jun 2013

Ghent, Belgium

Innovation & Publications

Patent Biodegradable materials technology

EP3727836A1,
US2021068355A1,
WO2019122197A1

Skills

- Product Leadership Strategy, discovery, roadmap, scaling
- AI & Technology Machine learning products, SaaS platforms
- Management Hiring, team leadership, stakeholder alignment
- Domain AgTech, EdTech, international development